democratically: by winning more popular support than they do, from those who should always "run" every free country—its people. Early in 2009, Zardari misguidedly tried to ban Nawaz Sharif and his brother Shahbaz from running for any political offices in the future, and also reaffirmed the illicit firing of Chief Justice Chaudhry. Nawaz refused to be intimidated, however, leading the start of a second great lawyers' march in defiance of Zardari's autocratic orders and continued failure to reappoint Chaudhry to his Supreme Court seat. Calling on all Pakistanis to "rise and revolt," Nawaz swiftly emerged as Pakistan's most popular leader, Zardari sinking to his lowest level in every poll. Shouts for Zardari to "Go!" were almost as loud as those which had led to Musharraf's fall the year before.

Prime Minister Gilani then happily announced on 16 March 2009 that the president's ruling had been rescinded, and Chief Justice Chaudhry was reappointed the same day. Whether Nawaz would return to his former post as prime minister or replace Zardari as president was as yet unclear, though he is the most powerful and popular politician in Pakistan and is likely to remain so for the foreseeable future. Two of the PPP's popular liberal leaders, Barrister Aitzaz Ahsan and Benazir Bhutto's London friend Sherry Rehman, who had quit Zardari's cabinet when he acted so dictatorially, might well join Nawaz in putting together a national coalition, which should have the support of Washington's new Democratic administration as well as Pakistan's popular majority. Meanwhile, Nawaz's brother Shahbaz Sharif reclaimed his former position in Lahore as Punjab's chief minister.

Chief Justice Chaudhry wasted no time in reassuming his role as Pakistan's foremost guardian of civil rights and justice for women as well as men. The brutality of Taliban terrorists in Swat, who had whipped a seventeen-year-old girl for appearing in public without a burka, was properly criticized by the Supreme Court's leader, who soundly reprimanded Pakistan's attorney general for ignoring such crimes instead of arresting their perpetrators. The chief justice, moreover, appointed a special panel to investigate ex-President Musharraf's possible high crimes and ordered Musharraf not to leave Pakistan pending a criminal trial, which was demanded by most of Pakistan's senators, led by Mian Raza Rabbani and Ilyas Bilour, who called him a "thief" and "dacoit."[3] Musharraf had flown off by then to London, however, and may opt never to return to stand trial. However, it now seems at least clear that the judicious spirit of Pakistan's founding father, Jinnah, has been revitalized by the brave chief justice of its